DAY 27 · THEORY HANDOUT

# Read a PDF Before Asking an LLM

Extract page text, keep page labels, and answer from the supplied text.

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# The idea and its useful terms



Extract page text, keep page labels, and answer from the supplied text.

### Document loader

Reads a file and returns text with extra details.

### page_content

The text stored inside a LangChain Document.

### Metadata

Details such as filename and page number.

An LLM does not open the PDF when we write its filename in a prompt. The loader first turns the file into usable text.

A scanned page may contain only a photo of words. OCR means reading words from an image; plain text extraction may return little.

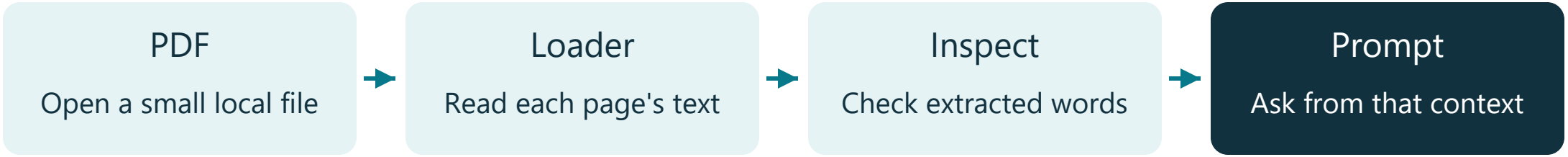
> Keep page numbers with the text. A page label makes an answer easier to check.

# Follow the work, one step at a time



Each step has a job. We can inspect its output before moving on.

Read the path from left to right.




Each arrow means: pass the result to the next step.

The loader returns a Document for each extracted page in this example. page_content holds the words; metadata keeps page and file details. We inspect both before placing the text in a prompt.

Machine page indexes often start at 0. Our visible page labels start at 1. Keep this difference clear when citing evidence. Joining all pages is fine for a small file; long files need a different reading plan.

> If the answer is wrong, inspect the input and the intermediate results. The last sentence alone cannot show which step failed.

# A small example we can check



The values here are classroom examples. The notebook shows actual results.

### Page 1

Class: Python.

Time: 10:00.

### Page 2

Class: Pandas.

Time: 11:00.

### Question

When is Pandas?

Use page 2 as evidence.

Read the given input first. Point to the fact or value needed for the requested output.

Run the matching example, then try the fresh input at the end of the notebook. Compare both results with the known input.

> Keep page numbers with the text. A page label makes an answer easier to check.

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# Choose the setting or tool for its job

A different choice changes the work. These are the choices we compare.

## Text PDF

Extract existing text.

Fast for our sample.

## Scanned PDF

Needs OCR.

Inspect its text first.

## Long PDF

May not fit in one prompt.

Use chunks later.

Load the supplied two-page PDF and print its page count and one page's metadata.

Ask a question whose answer appears on page 2.

> Ask for a fee the PDF never gives. Check whether the answer admits that it is missing.

# Practice, check, and read the full lesson



Use the notebook to try the steps. Use the article when you need the longer explanation.

### 1. Build

Run the small example.

Inspect each step.

### 2. Change

Try the fresh input.

Keep the goal clear.

### 3. Check

Compare with the source.

Keep mistakes visible.

Ask for a fee the PDF never gives. Check whether the answer admits that it is missing.

Read the complete tutorial breakdown for this section in our KGP Talkie article.

> Keep page numbers with the text. A page label makes an answer easier to check.

DAY 27 · COMPLETE

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